HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Kindness is a trap. If someone is gentle with me, they are getting ready to hurt me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Kindness is a trap. If someone is gentle with me, they are getting ready to hurt me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who used kindness badly, and who has not?
- ☐ What would slow trust look like, short of refusing everyone?
- ☐ Is this the same person, or a reminder in my body?
- ☐ What kindness have I received that did not turn into harm?
- ☐ How is God's care different from the care that was misused?
- ☐ What limit can I set while I am still receiving help?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Some kindness was misused, and that does not make all kindness a trap. I can go slowly, and I can receive care from safe people and from God.
- ☐ My alarm can be honored without becoming a law about everyone.
- ☐ God's care is not a setup.
- ☐ I can go slowly with a gentle person.
- ☐ I am allowed to receive help.
- ☐ One unsafe person does not equal every kind person.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Peter 5:7
  "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."
- ☐ John 14:27
  "Peace I leave with you; My peace I give to you. I do not give to you as the world gives. Do not let your hearts be troubled; do not be afraid."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ When kindness felt like a setup: Each day, write down one moment when gentleness made you brace for harm. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Peter 5:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can bring this fear to God, because His care is not a trap.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone. If you are not safe right now, call 911 or 1-800-799-7233.

- ☐ Name the old pattern and the present person. Two lines, no story: who misused kindness, and who is in front of you now.
- ☐ Receive one small help from someone you and your counselor consider safe. Write what they did afterward.
- ☐ Keep a limit. You can accept kindness and still say no to more than you want.
- ☐ Pray 1 Peter 5:7 when a gentle voice makes you brace.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Kindness is a trap. If someone is gentle with me, they are getting ready to hurt me.": _____ %

My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A kindness that did not turn into harm
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Kindness is a trap. If someone is gentle with me, they are getting ready to hurt me~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, kindness makes me brace. Some of that wisdom was earned. Teach me that not every gentle person is a trap, and that Your care is safe. Help me go slowly. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.